

Outlook

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Follow-up: payment retries need an outcome-level control

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Payment attempts, reversals and late postings can create apparent duplicates or genuine duplicate customer impact. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. Different teams have produced different answers from the same period, so population and timing rules need to be visible.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if late settlement creates false duplicates?
2. What evidence would instead support that some customers were debited more than once before reversal?
3. How do we rule out that retries are correctly linked?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use February 2022 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards the matching rule, customer-impact list and preventive control. A useful output would be a model-ready table, data dictionary and an honest baseline.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Statement evidence is available only for selected accounts; use transaction identifiers and timing for the full population.

Regards